

Progressive Wage Model

Companies must meet the PWM requirements for food services workers who are Singapore citizens or permanent residents.

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Food services sector

Companies must meet the PWM requirements for food services workers who are Singapore citizens or permanent residents.

What is it

The **Progressive Wage Model (PWM)** for food services workers was developed by the Tripartite Cluster for Food Services Industry (TCF). It features:

- **Training requirements** that tap on the **Skills Framework for Food Services** [\[1\]](#). This ensures that workers have the skills they need to carry out their jobs.
- **Progressive wages set at each level**. This ensures that workers are paid wages that correspond to their skills and productivity.

Employers **must meet the PWM requirements** to renew existing work passes or apply for new work passes.

Click [here](#) [\[2\]](#) for an overview of the Food Services PWM.

Who it covers

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The PWM requirements cover all Singapore citizens and permanent residents who **fulfil both of the following conditions**:

- Employed as full-time or part-time food services employees on a contract of service, working in a premise that has a **Singapore Food Agency** [\[1\]](#) Food Retail or Food Processing (Central Kitchen) licence.
- Employed by firms which hire foreign workers, regardless of whether the firm is classified under the Food and Beverage Service Activities Singapore Standard Industrial Classification (SSIC) or another SSIC.

The food services PWM covers the following food services job roles in two categories of establishments:

Category A

- Quick-Service (QS) food establishments, such as fast-food outlets, food courts, food kiosks, and eating houses where customers self-collect food or drink orders from food service counters
- Supermarkets with ready-to-eat food stations

Senior Cook (QS)

Responsibilities:

- Direct and manage the preparation of menu dishes at one or more kitchen stations
- Apply culinary techniques to prepare food according to the establishment's standard recipes and operating procedures
- Support the sous chef and head chef in the development of new menu dishes
- May oversee one or more kitchen assistants, cooks or other kitchen staff

Examples of jobs covered:

- Chef de Partie
- Station chef

Cook (QS)

Responsibilities:

- Supports the preparation of menu dishes

- Assemble ingredients or kitchen equipment prior to preparation of menu dishes, according to the establishment or senior cook's requirements
- Apply culinary techniques to prepare food according to the establishment's standard recipes and operating procedures
- Supervise kitchen assistants
- Maintain cleanliness of kitchen stations and upkeep of cooking equipment
- Prepare batches of food that are cooked to order, or kept warm until ordered and sold

Examples of jobs covered:

- Commis chef
- Line cook
- Pastry chef
- Baker

Kitchen assistant (QS)

Responsibilities:

- Handle basic food preparation
- Prepare ingredients for cooking according to the establishment's standard recipes and operating procedures
- Portion, assemble or package menu dishes and other food items
- Process new inventory items and inventory checking
- Clean food preparation areas, kitchen stations, equipment, tables, cutlery and crockery
- Prepare food items for ready consumption
- Provide counter service, where needed
- Collect payment from customers and perform other cashiering duties
- Package food / drinks for takeaways

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Examples of jobs covered:

- Kitchen assistant
- Kitchen crew
- Bakery assistant

Food service counter attendant

Responsibilities:

- Prepare or serve simple food / drink items from counters or steam tables in food shops
- Take customer orders and communicate orders to the kitchen
- Collect payment from customers and perform cashiering duties
- Handle commercial or industrial-grade equipment, e.g. coffee machines, deep fryer, griddles
- Manage online orders, e.g. via digital platforms

Examples of jobs covered:

- Fast-food service crew
- Bubble tea shop service crew
- Salad counter server
- Roast grill counter attendant

Food / drink stall assistant

Responsibilities:

- Prepare or serve simple food / drink items from counters or steam tables in food stalls

- Take customer orders and communicate orders to the kitchen
- Collect payment from customers and perform cashiering duties

Examples of jobs covered:

- Food court stall assistant
- Coffeeshop stall assistant

Category B

- Full-Service (FS) food establishments, such as establishments that employ wait staff or banquet servers and are not under Category A
- Caterers
- Central kitchens

Senior Cook

Responsibilities:

- Direct and manage the preparation of menu dishes at one or more kitchen stations
- Apply culinary techniques to prepare food according to the establishment's standard recipes and operating procedures, where applicable
- Support the sous chef and head chef in the development of new menu dishes
- May oversee one or more kitchen assistants, cooks, or other kitchen staff

Examples of jobs covered:

- Chef de Partie
- Station chef

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Cook (FS)

Responsibilities:

- Supports the preparation of menu dishes
- Assemble ingredients or kitchen equipment prior to preparation of menu dishes, according to the establishment or senior cook's requirements
- Apply culinary techniques to prepare food according to the establishment's standard recipes and operating procedures
- Supervise kitchen assistants
- Maintain cleanliness of kitchen stations and upkeep of cooking equipment
- Follow the senior cook's instructions for the preparation of menu items and meeting of other operational needs
- Support compliance with food safety and sanitation requirements, in areas such as product rotation, temperature maintenance, storage procedures, and food handling techniques

Examples of jobs covered:

- Commis chef
- Line cook
- Pastry chef
- Baker

Kitchen assistant (FS)

Responsibilities:

- Handle basic food preparation
- Prepare ingredients for cooking according to the establishment's standard recipes and operating procedures

- Portion, assemble or package menu dishes and other food items
- Process new inventory items and inventory checking
- Clean food preparation areas, kitchen stations, equipment, tables, cutlery and crockery
- Assist in cooking and plating of menu dishes according to the kitchen manual, where applicable

Examples of jobs covered:

- Kitchen assistant
- Kitchen crew
- Bakery assistant

Manager

Responsibilities:

- Bear overall responsibility for the profitability of the establishment
- Oversee all of the establishment's operations, i.e. both customer-facing and back of house activities, e.g. kitchen, inventory management

Examples of jobs covered:

- Restaurant manager
- Outlet manager

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Waiter supervisor

Responsibilities:

- Support the manager by overseeing customer-facing operations
- Coordinate, manage or train waiters and other customer-facing employees
- Supervise customer interactions and intervene where necessary
- Ensure compliance with regulations, as well as establishment's own service protocols and standards
- Schedule working shifts of waiters and other customer-facing employees based on operational needs
- Manage payroll and manpower budget for waiters and other customer-facing employees

Examples of jobs covered:

- Waiter supervisor

Waiter

Responsibilities:

- Attend directly to customers' needs and supports customer-facing operations
- Prepare tables for service, greet walk-in customers, and escort them to their tables
- Respond to customer enquiries and take reservations over telephone
- Take customer orders and communicate orders to the kitchen – may be done manually
- Serve food/drinks from kitchen to customers
- Collect payment from customers and perform other cashiering duties

Examples of jobs covered:

- Waiter
- Banquet server

Tip

If you need help with identifying your PWM job classification, you may use our [PWM self-assessment tool](#) .

Wage requirements

Wage requirements for **part-time employees** are pro-rated on a 44-hours basis.

The TCF will undertake a review of the wage schedule in 2028.

The current wage requirements and overtime multiplier, which were in effect from 1 March 2023, will continue to apply until 30 June 2026, when the updated PWM wage schedule takes effect.

Category A (Quick Services)

Job roles	Monthly gross wage requirements (excluding overtime payments) for full-time food services workers (35-44 hours per week)			
	1 Mar 2025 - 30 Jun 2026	1 Jul 2026 - 30 Jun 2027	1 Jul 2027 - 30 Jun 2028	1 Jul 2028 - 30 Jun 2029
Senior cook	Left to market forces			
 Cook (QS)	≥ \$2,330	≥ \$2,470	≥ \$2,610	
 Kitchen assistant (QS) / Food service counter attendant	≥ \$2,155	≥ \$2,295	≥ \$2,435	≥ \$2,575
 Food / drink stall assistant	≥ \$2,080	≥ \$2,220	≥ \$2,360	≥ \$2,500

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Job roles	Hourly gross wage requirements for part-time food services workers			
	1 Mar 2025 - 30 Jun 2026	1 Jul 2026 - 30 Jun 2027	1 Jul 2027 - 30 Jun 2028	1 Jul 2028 - 30 Jun 2029
Senior cook	Left to market forces			
 Cook (QS)	≥ \$12.22	≥ \$12.95	≥ \$13.69	≥ \$14.42
 Kitchen assistant (QS) / Food service counter attendant	≥ \$11.30	≥ \$12.04	≥ \$12.77	≥ \$13.51
 Food / drink stall assistant	≥ \$10.91	≥ \$11.64	≥ \$12.38	≥ \$13.11

Category B (Full Service Kitchen Assistant, Cook and Senior Cook)

Job roles	<u>Monthly gross wage</u> requirements (excluding overtime payments) for full-time food services workers (35-44 hours per week)			
	1 Mar 2025 - 30 Jun 2026	1 Jul 2026 - 30 Jun 2027	1 Jul 2027 - 30 Jun 2028	1 Jul 2028 - 30 Jun 2029
Senior cook	Left to market forces			
 Cook (FS)	≥ \$2,380	≥ \$2,520	≥ \$2,660	≥ \$2,800
 Kitchen assistant (FS)	≥ \$2,180	≥ \$2,320	≥ \$2,460	≥ \$2,600

Job roles	Hourly gross wage requirements for part-time food services workers			
	1 Mar 2025 - 30 Jun 2026	1 Jul 2026 - 30 Jun 2027	1 Jul 2027 - 30 Jun 2028	1 Jul 2028 - 30 Jun 2029
Senior cook	Left to market forces			
 Cook (FS)	≥ \$12.48	≥ \$13.22	≥ \$13.95	≥  Find & Summarise
 Kitchen assistant (FS)	≥ \$11.43	≥ \$12.17	≥ \$12.90	≥ \$13.64

Category B (Full Service Waiter)

Job roles	<u>Monthly gross wage</u> requirements (excluding overtime payments) for full-time food services workers (35-44 hours per week)			
	1 Mar 2025 - 30 Jun 2026	1 Jul 2026 - 30 Jun 2027	1 Jul 2027 - 30 Jun 2028	1 Jul 2028 - 30 Jun 2029
Manager	Left to market forces			
 Waiter Supervisor	≥ \$2,730	≥ \$2,875	≥ \$3,020	≥ \$3,165
 Waiter	≥ \$2,180	≥ \$2,320	≥ \$2,460	≥ \$2,600

Job roles	Hourly gross wage requirements for part-time food services workers			
	1 Mar 2025 - 30 Jun 2026	1 Jul 2026 - 30 Jun 2027	1 Jul 2027 - 30 Jun 2028	1 Jul 2028 - 30 Jun 2029
Manager	Left to market forces			
 Waiter Supervisor	≥ \$14.32	≥ \$15.08	≥ \$15.84	≥ \$16.60
 Waiter	≥ \$11.43	≥ \$12.17	≥ \$12.90	≥ \$13.64

Note

Total monthly gross wage (for full-time work of 35-44 hours per week) refers to the sum of:

- Basic wage
- Allowances, e.g. travel, food, and housing
- Productivity incentive payments

It excludes:

- Bonuses, e.g. Annual Wage Supplement
- Stock options
- Reimbursement of special expenses incurred in the course of employment
- Payments-in-kind
- Employer CPF contributions

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Additional PWM gross wage requirements for overtime

Employers must meet additional requirements for full-time employees who **fulfil both of the following conditions**:

- work more than 44 hours a week.
- are covered by **Part 4 of the Employment Act**.

Employers must pay these employees according to both of the following conditions:

- **An overtime rate of pay at least 1.5 times the basic rate of pay**, according to overtime requirements under Part 4 of the Employment Act.
- **A monthly gross wage of at least the PWM gross wage requirements for overtime hours before 1 July 2026  and from 1 July 2026 .**

Tip

Employees can check their salary information, job details, and if employers are paying them the correct wages using the  **Progressive Wage Portal (PW Portal)**. Refer to the infographic for an **overview of the PW Portal**.

Training requirements

Employers must ensure that their Singapore citizen and permanent resident food services workers meet the following training requirements:

- **Senior cook and manager**: Training from the list of approved Workforce Skills Qualification (WSQ) modules is encouraged, but not mandatory. Employers have the flexibility to train employees according to their own business needs.
- **All other Food Service PWM job roles**: 2 WSQ modules from the list of approved modules or relevant Institute of Higher Learning (IHL) qualification conferred by MOE-registered educational institutions.
- **If employer has attained in-house approved training organisation (ATO) status**: in-house WSQ training modules with prefix “FSS” in the Technical Skills & Competencies (TSC) code can be used to meet training requirements as well.

Employers will be given a grace period to comply with the training requirements:

- For new hires: six months from date of employment

Through proper training, food services workers will be able to increase their productivity, skillsets, and offer good food service experiences to customers.

For more details on the training requirements, the list of approved modules and relevant IHL qualifications, please see **Annex C of the TCF report** .

Find out more

For more information:

- **TCF's report and recommendations issued in 2026** 
- **TCF's report and recommendations issued in 2023** 



Related questions

How do I know if my employees are covered under the food services PWM?

Are hawkers and individual food stall holders expected to comply with the food services PWM wage and training requirements?



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